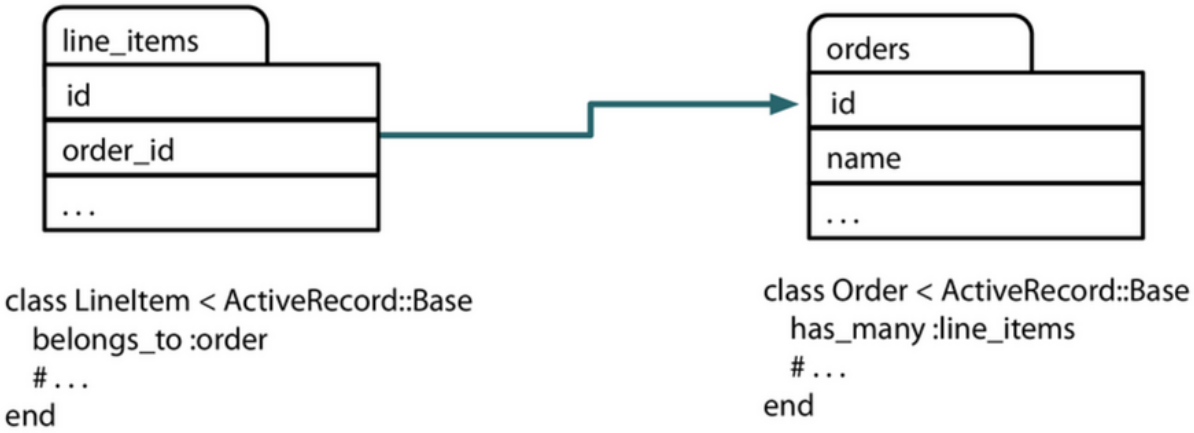
the database, all the line item rows for a particular order contain a foreign key column referring to that order, as shown in the figure.



In Active Record, the parent object (the one that logically contains a collection of child objects) uses `has_many` to declare its relationship to the child table, and the child table uses `belongs_to` to indicate its parent. In our example, class `LineItem belongs_to :order`, and the `orders` table `has_many :line_items`.

Note that, again, because the line item contains the foreign key, it has the `belongs_to` declaration.

Many-to-Many Relationships

Finally, we might categorize our products. A product can belong to many categories, and each category may contain multiple products. This is an example of a *many-to-many* relationship. It's as if each side of the relationship contains a collection of items on the other side.